Temperament Field Notes

Field notes, not a report card. Neither end of any trait is the good end.

Child's first name or nickname _____ **Age** _____

Page 1 of 3: your child. How to use this page

1 = little or low, 3 = right in the middle, 5 = a lot or high.
Pick the number closest to how they usually are, not their best or worst day.
Babies and toddlers: picture them on an ordinary day. Older kids: picture a slightly new or uncomfortable setting.

Arriving somewhere a little new

1. Approach / Withdrawal

When something or someone is new, how do they respond?

1 = holds back and watches first — *5 = moves toward it right away*

○ 1 ○ 2 ○ 3 ○ 4 ○ 5

2. Activity level

How much do they move?

1 = calm and still — *5 = always on the move*

○ 1 ○ 2 ○ 3 ○ 4 ○ 5

3. Sensitivity

How much do they notice noise, light, textures, or changes in the room?

1 = barely registers — *5 = notices everything*

○ 1 ○ 2 ○ 3 ○ 4 ○ 5

4. Mood

What is their general lens?

1 = serious and watchful — *5 = cheerful and open*

○ 1 ○ 2 ○ 3 ○ 4 ○ 5

Across an ordinary week

5. Regularity

How predictable are their hunger, sleep, and routines?

1 = varies day to day — *5 = like clockwork*

○ 1 ○ 2 ○ 3 ○ 4 ○ 5

Working on something hard

6. Persistence

When it's frustrating, do they keep going?

1 = moves on quickly — *5 = sticks with it*

○ 1 ○ 2 ○ 3 ○ 4 ○ 5

7. Distractibility

How easily are they pulled away by what's happening around them?

1 = stays locked in — *5 = easily pulled away*

○ 1 ○ 2 ○ 3 ○ 4 ○ 5

8. Adaptability

When plans change, how quickly do they adjust?

1 = needs time to reset — *5 = adjusts quickly*

○ 1 ○ 2 ○ 3 ○ 4 ○ 5

9. Intensity of reaction

How big are their reactions, upset or delighted?

1 = even and quiet — *5 = big and expressive*

○ 1 ○ 2 ○ 3 ○ 4 ○ 5

Notes to myself

Your answers stay on your device: save a copy or print this page. Nine traits from Thomas & Chess.

Laura Lorber, J.D. | Gradient Resolutions

Temperament Field Notes: You

Same nine traits, now about you. Neither end of any trait is the good end.

Your first name

Page 2 of 3: you. How to use this page

Same scale: 1 = little or low, 3 = right in the middle, 5 = a lot or high.
Pick the number closest to how you usually are, not your best or worst day.
Picture yourself in a slightly new or uncomfortable moment, like pulling up at a handoff.

Arriving somewhere a little new

1. Approach / Withdrawal

When something or someone is new, how do you respond?

1 = holds back and watches first — *5 = moves toward it right away*

1 ○ 2 ○ 3 ○ 4 ○ 5

2. Activity level

How much do you move?

1 = calm and still — *5 = always on the move*

1 ○ 2 ○ 3 ○ 4 ○ 5

3. Sensitivity

How much do you notice noise, light, textures, or changes in the room?

1 = barely registers — *5 = notices everything*

1 ○ 2 ○ 3 ○ 4 ○ 5

4. Mood

What is your general lens?

1 = serious and watchful — *5 = cheerful and open*

1 ○ 2 ○ 3 ○ 4 ○ 5

Across an ordinary week

5. Regularity

How predictable are your hunger, sleep, and routines?

1 = varies day to day — *5 = like clockwork*

1 ○ 2 ○ 3 ○ 4 ○ 5

Working on something hard

6. Persistence

When it's frustrating, do you keep going?

1 = moves on quickly — *5 = sticks with it*

1 ○ 2 ○ 3 ○ 4 ○ 5

7. Distractibility

How easily are you pulled away by what's happening around you?

1 = stays locked in — *5 = easily pulled away*

1 ○ 2 ○ 3 ○ 4 ○ 5

8. Adaptability

When plans change, how quickly do you adjust?

1 = needs time to reset — *5 = adjusts quickly*

1 ○ 2 ○ 3 ○ 4 ○ 5

9. Intensity of reaction

How big are your reactions, upset or delighted?

1 = even and quiet — *5 = big and expressive*

1 ○ 2 ○ 3 ○ 4 ○ 5

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Side by Side

Where you and your child are close, where you are far apart, and where to get curious.

Child _____ Me _____

Page 3 of 3: the two side by side. How to use this page

Your numbers from pages 1 and 2 appear here in Adobe Acrobat and most desktop viewers.
If they don't, type them in. 'Steps apart' is the distance between the two numbers.
Close numbers can still clash, and far-apart numbers can balance each other. Get curious, not critical.

Trait	Child	Me	Steps apart	What this might mean at the handoff
1. Approach / Withdrawal				
2. Activity level				
3. Sensitivity				
4. Mood				
5. Regularity				
6. Persistence				
7. Distractibility				
8. Adaptability				
9. Intensity of reaction				

Where we are close

Where we are far apart

If your co-parent would rate your child differently, that isn't evidence against either of you. Two people are seeing the same plant in different light.